

Chapter 40-5

Liang Shi ate while scrolling through comments.

[What kind of heaven-defying script does Xu Qingzhu have! Academic genius! Universe-level divine beauty! Elite!]

[Compared to this, I'm like someone sent from heaven to make up the numbers.]

[Her temperament is really too outstanding, wuwuwu¹, sister please kill me.]

[I'll speak plainly, I want to sleep with her. doge²]

[Sigh, who doesn't want to?]

[...]

Xu Qingzhu had very high discussion levels online, mainly because of several beautiful animated GIFs that had circulated.

One was of her smiling with curved lips, another was of her tucking her hair behind her ear.

Netizens were calling out to film and television companies.

[Can all workplace dramas from now on please roll up to this standard?]

[Hey, can someone sign her to act? My Alpha DNA is stirring.]

[Also, my CP-shipping³ DNA is stirring. Does anyone else think her temperament mysteriously matches Yang Shuyan?]

[Heaven-conquering earth-conquering cool sister big villain Alpha X wealthy family princess bright and beautiful white-lotus-turned-dark⁴ Omega!!!]

[I can do this, sisters do you have videos?!]

[I have pictures!]

[...]

Liang Shi was like a little animal in a melon field⁵, following the clues given by netizens to trace the vine and find the melon, eventually reaching that Weibo post.

There was a picture edited by a blogger.

Yang Shuyan wearing a black and gold evening gown stood in the corner, while Xu Qingzhu had a face full of smiles, but her eyes were completely cold.

Imagining it in one's mind didn't seem that compatible, but when this picture with excellent atmosphere came out, netizens all transformed into CP-shipping machines.

[Let me ship them! I can do this!]

[Even though Miss Xu hasn't entered the entertainment industry yet, I'm already imagining what dramas she'll film.]

[Really begging, which company can poach her to act, I'll kneel in thanks.]

[...]

[For a moment I don't know if you're joking or serious. She's at least the legal heir of a company, why would a female boss stop being a boss to become a female celebrity? That would be crazy.]

[Friendly reminder, this person is married.]

[Another friendly reminder, Yang Shuyan's fans will arrive at the battlefield in three seconds, everyone save yourselves.]

[...]

Liang Shi vigorously liked that "married" comment.

Looking at that edited picture, she clicked report.

How could they put Xu Qingzhu and Yang Shuyan together?!

They clearly don't match at all!

Xu Qingzhu's official Alpha hasn't appeared yet!

The rumored elite returnee⁶, fluent in ten languages, with outstanding temperament, gentle and kind, filial and family-loving, emotionally devoted Lu Jiayi.

But now... the storyline had already deviated a little bit.

Would this official Alpha still appear?

Or would she only appear after she and Xu Qingzhu divorced?

"Rather than worrying about these meaningless questions, why not worry about your additional task?" The system's eerie voice suddenly rang in her mind, startling Liang Shi.

She rolled her eyes, "Why do you appear and disappear like a ghost?!"

"I'm here to remind you that your additional task has 56 hours left before expiring. Please pay attention to the task deadline. PS: Procrastination is the most annoying thing. Another PS: If you don't complete the task because of procrastination, that would be even more annoying." The system's eerie mechanical voice made Liang Shi feel numb, and she answered: "Okay, I'll do it tomorrow."

System: "I'm mainly worried about you, host. Your misfortune value has accumulated to 7, just a little bit more and it will trigger a level-one punishment."

Liang Shi: "..."

When did she offend Xu Qingzhu again?!

She perfunctorily dealt with the system and continued playing with the two children for a while.

When sending Rainbow home, it started raining outside again.

Under the dim yellow lights, fine rain threads were entangled, and raindrops danced aimlessly in the air.

Grooves kept winding across the car windows, and the windshield wipers worked diligently.

There was only one umbrella in the car. Liang Shi let Ling Dang stay in the car and walked Rainbow home under the umbrella before coming back down.

Originally she wanted to drive straight home, but when passing Jiangyu Road, she changed direction and drove to Xu Qingzhu's company.

Ling Dang sat in the car playing on her iPad, watching that dark-themed cartoon "Don't Cry, Rabbit" with great interest.

Liang Shi called Xu Qingzhu, but no one answered.

Given this person's previous habit of forgetting to charge her phone and having it turned off frequently, she called Lin Luoxi instead.

Lin Luoxi didn't answer either.

But shortly after, Xu Qingzhu called back.

"Are you still at the company?" Liang Shi asked.

The background noise on Xu Qingzhu's end was noisy, and it took a while before it became slightly quieter, "At a restaurant, everyone came out for a celebration banquet."

Liang Shi asked: "Have you been drinking?"

Xu Qingzhu suddenly laughed lightly, her voice casual and lazy, "Mm, had a little."

"Is it almost over?" Liang Shi asked again.

Xu Qingzhu said: "Almost, are you home?"

"On my way home." Liang Shi said: "Send me the address, I'll come pick you up."

"No need, you go back." Xu Qingzhu said: "I'll call a designated driver⁷ in a bit."

"It's too late, it's not safe." Liang Shi insisted, "Send me the location, I'll pick you all up."

After a moment, Xu Qingzhu compromised, "Alright."

Liang Shi stared at the location and turned at the next intersection.

Footnotes:

- ¹ **wuwuwu:** An onomatopoeia for crying sounds, commonly used in Chinese internet slang to express being moved to tears or overwhelming emotions.
- ² **doge:** An internet meme featuring a Shiba Inu dog, often used to indicate joking or playful intent in online comments.
- ³ **CP-shipping:** "CP" stands for "couple" and refers to fans pairing up characters or real people romantically. "Shipping" means supporting a romantic relationship between two characters.
- ⁴ **White-lotus-turned-dark:** A character archetype in Chinese web novels. A "white lotus" appears pure and innocent on the surface, while "turned dark" means they reveal a manipulative or evil nature underneath.
- ⁵ **Little animal in a melon field:** A reference to the Chinese idiom about a little animal (獾) that steals melons, used here metaphorically to describe someone following clues to dig up gossip.
- ⁶ **Elite returnee:** Refers to someone who studied abroad (usually in prestigious Western universities) and returned to China, often considered highly accomplished and westernized.
- ⁷ **Designated driver:** A service common in China where a professional driver is called to drive someone home in their own car when they've been drinking, rather than using a taxi or ride-sharing service.